



PortCast: The 5-Minute “Simple Analogies” Pitch Guide

Everything You Need to Know in Plain English — No Complex Math, Just Big Ideas & Real-World Analogies



THE 4 “GOLDEN ANALOGIES” (Use these in your pitch!)

1 What is PortCast?



The “Google Flights for Trillion-Dollar Ships” Analogy: “When you book a flight on Google Flights, it tells you: ‘Wait 4 days, prices will drop by \$150.’ **PortCast does the exact same thing for giant cargo ships carrying coal and iron ore into India.** It tells power plants and steel mills: ‘**Don’t book today—wait until Day +12 when freight rates hit their lowest point, saving you \$500,000 on a single shipment.**’”

2 What is the “Haldia Sandheads” Port Problem?



The “Landing a Jumbo Jet on a Grass Runway” Analogy: “Haldia Port in West Bengal is very shallow—only 8.5 meters deep. Bringing a massive 180,000-tonne ship into Haldia is like **trying to land an Airbus A380 on a tiny village grass runway—it will crash and get stuck in the mud.** Ships are forced to stop miles offshore at a place called ‘**Sandheads**’ to slowly transfer cargo into small boats (called **Lighterage**), which costs an extra **\$5.25 per tonne** and wastes 4 days. **PortCast warns charterers instantly and recommends deepwater Dhamra Port instead, saving \$210,000.**”

3 What is the “Vessel Capacity Utilization Bar”?

 **The “Hiring a 50-Seater Luxury Bus for 2 People” Analogy:** “If you have 40,000 tonnes of coal, but you hire a massive 180,000-tonne Capesize ship, **you are paying fuel and daily rent for 140,000 tonnes of empty air!** That’s why the capacity bar shows **Rose/Red (22%)**. PortCast automatically selects a **Supramax ship (58,000 tonnes)**, turning the bar **Emerald Green (85% efficiency)** so you don’t waste money.”

4 What are the “What-If” Sliders?

 **The “Uber Surge Pricing Simulator” Analogy:** “On a rainy Friday night, Uber prices surge because of rain and traffic jams. In shipping, freight prices surge when **Bunker Fuel (oil) spikes** or **ports get jammed with queues (congestion)**. Our **What-If Sliders** let managers drag the fuel price or delay days to simulate the surge **BEFORE** they sign a contract.”



SCREEN-BY-SCREEN CHEAT SHEET (What to Point at & Say)

1. OVERVIEW DASHBOARD (#dashboard)
 - WHAT IT IS: Morning briefing in 10 seconds.
 - WHAT TO SAY: "Here we track live freight rates (\$/MT), ship fuel prices, and waiting times at Paradip, Vizag, and Haldia."
2. FREIGHT FORECASTER (#forecaster) – THE HEART OF THE APP
 - WHAT IT IS: 30-day future shipping price predictor.
 - WHAT TO POINT AT:
 1. The 30-Day Heatmap Strip (under chart):
 - Blue cells = CHEAP DAYS (Good time to buy).
 - Orange cells = EXPENSIVE DAYS (Bad time to buy).
 - Gold Star (★) = THE CHEAPEST DAY (e.g. Day +12).
 2. The What-If Sliders: Drag the Fuel slider +20% and show how the graph shifts upward in real time.
3. CHARTER OPTIMIZER (#optimizer)
 - WHAT IT IS: The Ship & Port Matchmaker.
 - WHAT TO SAY: "Compares 4 ship sizes (Handysize, Supramax, Panamax,

- Capesize) to find the cheapest transport cost per tonne."
- THE TRICK TO SHOW: Select Haldia Port -> show the amber Sandheads warning and lighterage barge fee (+\$5.25/MT).

4. RISK RADAR (#risk)

- WHAT IT IS: Geopolitical Warning Radar.
- WHAT TO SAY: "Monitors trouble spots like the Red Sea and Malacca Strait, showing how missile detours add 12 days and \$380,000 in fuel."



THE 5 MAJOR TERMS EXPLAINED IN 10 WORDS OR LESS

1. **Dry Bulk:** Loose commodities like **Coal, Iron Ore, and Grain** moved in giant ship holds.
2. **Charterer:** The company **renting the ship** (e.g. Tata Steel or NTPC importing coal).
3. **Fixture:** The **final contract booking date** for hiring a ship.
4. **Draft:** How deep the ship sits in the water. (*Big ship = deep draft = needs deep port*).
5. **Demurrage:** The **\$18,000/day late penalty** you pay if your ship is stuck waiting outside a crowded port.



YOUR 2-MINUTE WINNING PITCH SCRIPT

*"Good morning, respected judges.

India imports over 200 million tonnes of coal every year to power our grid and manufacture steel. But hiring a cargo ship is like trading volatile stocks—rates swing by **\$15,000 a day**, and shallow ports like Haldia trap large vessels, forcing expensive barge transfers.

PortCast is like Google Flights for trillion-dollar cargo ships.

1. **On our Dashboard:** We give operators real-time visibility on shipping rates and port wait times.
2. **In our Freight Forecaster:** Our machine learning models predict shipping rates 30 days ahead with **94% directional accuracy**. Look at this heatmap strip: the **Gold Star (★)** tells charterers exactly which day rates hit their lowest point to lock in their contract.
3. **In our Charter Optimizer:** We right-size the ship class to prevent paying for empty space, and warn charterers when a ship is too heavy for shallow ports like Haldia.

4. **In our Risk Radar:** We simulate geopolitical shocks like Red Sea detours before they cost millions.

PortCast replaces broker phone calls with quantitative intelligence, saving Indian importers an average of **14.2% on every voyage**.

Thank you!“*

Created for fast, easy presentation preparation.